

# Risk Assessment Canvas

**Version 1.0-draft** · Use with: any proposed experiment or initiative before funding

A one-page canvas to make the risk of an innovation bet explicit before money and reputation are attached. Fill it in one sitting, as a group, in under an hour. If you can't fill a box, that gap is your first risk.

PDF rendering: generate from this Markdown (see repo README → Building PDFs).

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## Canvas

**Initiative name:** \_\_\_\_\_ **Date:** \_\_\_\_\_ **Owner:** \_\_\_\_\_

### 1. The bet

One sentence: we believe that [doing X] will result in [outcome Y] for [whom], and we'll know within [timeframe].

### 2. Kill criteria (write these FIRST)

What evidence, by what date, means we stop? If you cannot write a kill criterion, you are not running an experiment — you are making a commitment. Be honest about which.

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| Criterion | Measured how | Check date |
|-----------|--------------|------------|
|-----------|--------------|------------|

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### 3. Assumption stack

List the assumptions this bet rests on, riskiest first. Mark each: **T** = testable cheaply now, **D** = testable only by doing it, **F** = article of faith.

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| # | Assumption | T/D/F | Test (if T) |
|---|------------|-------|-------------|
| 1 |            |       |             |

| # | Assumption | T/D/F | Test (if T) |
|---|------------|-------|-------------|
| 2 |            |       |             |
| 3 |            |       |             |

#### 4. Blast radius

If this fails completely, what is damaged?

- **Money at risk (capped at):** \_\_\_\_\_
- **People (FTE-months):** \_\_\_\_\_
- **Customer exposure:** none / beta group / production users
- **Brand/regulatory exposure:** \_\_\_\_\_
- **Irreversible consequences, if any:** \_\_\_\_\_

#### 5. Mutation exposure (the risk of NOT doing it)

What does it cost to be wrong in the other direction? If the signal behind this bet is real and we sit still, what happens in 12-24 months? This box exists because boards systematically price action risk and ignore inaction risk.

#### 6. Decision

☐ Fund as experiment (kill criteria armed) ☐ Fund as commitment (say so explicitly) ☐ Park (re-review date: \_\_\_\_\_) ☐ Decline

**Decided by:** \_\_\_\_\_ **Date:** \_\_\_\_\_ **Review date:** \_\_\_\_\_

### Facilitation notes

- Fill **section 2 before section 1 is polished** — kill criteria written after a pitch is loved are theater.
- Section 5 is the canvas's reason to exist. An initiative with moderate blast radius and severe mutation exposure should beat a safe initiative with zero upside. Make that comparison visible at the portfolio level (see [innovation-kpi-scorecard.md](#)).
- Revisit the canvas at every check date. A canvas filed and forgotten is a risk register, and risk registers don't change decisions.